

TIPS & TRICKS

SECRETS THAT KEEP YOU AHEAD IN THE RACE

TIPS

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Adobe Photoshop CS4

Adobe Photoshop CS4 presents a spanking new interface with a bunch of small, thoughtful touches. For example, the titlebar has been removed entirely, allowing more space for the images to display. The cursor now changes from black to white depending on the background, which ensures that it is visible at all times. The usually empty space after the menu bar is filled with tools. Essentially, not a single inch of screen space has been put to waste. The immediate effect is that you have a much larger work area at your disposal. There are also new features for the power user, most noticeably, a panel view for working with multiple documents at once. Another welcome addition is that of a tabbed arrangement when multiple files are open; where you can undock single images.

Working with layers

Every time you wish to make a change to an image, it makes sense to make those changes in a new layer. This measure preserves the original image, despite any adjustments you make. Go to Layer > Duplicate Layer to duplicate the image in a new layer. To make image adjustments, use the Layer > New Adjustment

Layer option. The submenu in this option is the same as the submenu in Image > Adjustments. Every time you select an adjustment layer, you will see the options available for image adjustments. This means that you can repeatedly tweak image adjustments in multiple adjustment layers without having to go back and forth between image adjustments on a single layer. Every image adjustment layer is essentially a mask added to the image.

Using the Vibrancy adjustment filter

The Image adjustments tools are the backbone of photo-editing on Photoshop. A new feature in CS4 is the vibrancy control. By default, the middle left pane now has image adjustment tools shown for easy access. Go to Image > Adjustments > Vibrance. Vibrance

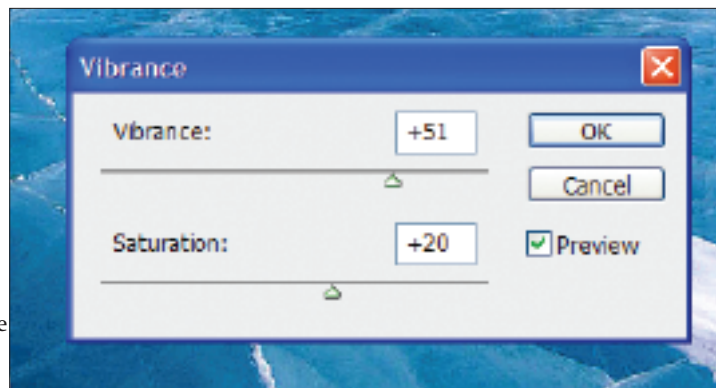
is noticeably different from saturation control, but it's a filter that works with the saturation of the colours in the image. What vibrance does is increase the saturation of all the colours in the photo, while cutting off the magnitude of this increase for the colours that are already saturated. This means that the areas in the image with a lower saturation get a bigger boost in saturation than the areas in the image with a higher saturation.

Using the Photo Filter

CS4 also has a new image adjustment feature known as the Photo Filter. Many features in Photoshop are named after similar techniques and equipment used by Photographers before the onset of digital photography. Photo Filters is a long overdue feature. Filters were additions to lenses that enhanced a particular colour (like green) or suppressed a particular part of the electromagnetic spectrum (like UV light). The Photo Filter option in CS4 has a bunch of presets which represent real-world filters available in the market for photographers. The logic of using a filter is thus: imagine a landscape with a lot of trees, you can then use a green filter to better reproduce the foliage, by enhancing the green in the image. The Photo Filter option in Photoshop lets you choose your own colour. You can use the colour picker to pick a colour from the image and apply the filter. Go to Image > Adjustments > Photo Filter.

Matching colours across different images

Often, a set of images taken at a particular location or an event, look like they have been taken at different times, as they look different. This can occur due to many reasons, like a large span of time between pictures or using multiple cameras at a time. To make the colours constant across images, CS4 has a match colour option. First, open up all the images you want to match the colour in, you will need a minimum of two images. Next, select a reference image, which will be the image you will use to source the colours from. Every time you match a colour in a particular picture, you will use the colours in your ref-



The new vibrance adjustment feature